tell you where your problems are. When you see performance problems, you should take the time in your current development cycle to fix or mitigate them.

6.2.2. Consumer usage

Another production monitoring strategy is to watch how your consumers are using your site. There are a number of ways to track page hits and site usage; two examples of off-the-shelf products are Google Analytics (www.google.com/analytics/) and Crittercism (www.crittercism.com/). These solutions not only track the number of people who are using your products, but also how long they spent on certain pages and how they flowed through the app, as well as something called *conversion rate*.

Conversion rate is determined by dividing whatever you decide is success criteria for using your application by total users. Success may be selling something, clicking on an advertisement, or making a connection with another user. Conversion tells you how successful you are at turning users into consumers.

Reacting to consumer usage

Trends in consumer usage help you determine how your application needs to evolve to better serve your consumer. If you have features that your consumers don't use, then why are they even in your product? Hone the most popular features in your application to ensure your consumers are getting the best possible experience you can offer.

Try to move your team to a model where you can do small, frequent releases. In each release be sure to measure the impact of the change you just deployed to help determine what feature to work on next.

6.2.3. Semantic logging analysis

How your consumers are using your system is key to continuously improving it. If you're collecting arbitrary metrics and page tracking, then